

JesusOnline Equip

Ministry Resources Hub

The Divine Right of the King

A free resource from JesusOnline Ministries.

Read or share online: app.jesonline.com/post/22220-058-the-divine-right-of-the-king

JesusOnline Equip · Ministry Resources Hub · equip.jesonline.com

Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

The Divine Right of the King

*Kings take pleasure in honest lips; they value a man who speaks the truth.
(Proverbs 16:13)*

*He who loves a pure heart and whose speech is gracious will have the king for
his friend. (Proverbs 22:11)*

*Do you see a man skilled in his work? He will serve before kings; he will not
serve before obscure men. (Proverbs 22:29)*

*Do not exalt yourself in the king's presence, and do not claim a place among
great men; it is better for him to say to you, "Come up here," than for him to
humiliate you before a nobleman. (Proverbs 25:6-7)*

For all their benefits, democracies cheat their citizens of a number of valuable life lessons. One is learning to relate to absolute authority. Human nature—bent as it is toward rebellion—is taught submission only through the discipline of dealing with authority against which there is no appeal. When a king speaks, it is a final answer. When a president speaks, it may well be subject to appeal, veto, or negotiability. It is that perception of negotiability that gives a foot in the door for man's rebellion...and its consequences.

When I was in college ROTC, I was taught a very alien and often-despised concept called "military authority." Bringing my democratic presuppositions and youthful arrogance to the military environment cost me many hours of labor working off "demerits" administered because of my lack of submission to the officers over me. I was told the only acceptable answers were, "Yes, sir," "No, sir," and "No excuse, sir." Awful...but wonderful. I learned my heart of rebellion and ways to respond to nonnegotiable authority. The military chain of command taught me how to respond to God.

Proverbs teaches principles for relating successfully to those in authority—husbands, bosses, police, governors, and God. Following them is a key to better relationships, even if their authority is not "absolute."

Watchman Nee, in his book *Spiritual Authority*, teaches that in every situation a believer is to be keenly aware of two dynamics—the presence of sin and the presence of authority. He also taught that the righteous person “keeps his peace and keeps his place.”

Principle: Asking yourself, “Is there sin here?” and “Who’s in authority here?” will quickly reveal the moral compass for a situation—avoid the sin and submit to the authority.

There is a pecking order even among high-level authorities. The general can overrule the captain and the captain the sergeant. In like manner, in the heavenly chain of authority, there is one authority that transcends all others. He is called the “King of all kings.”

Principle: If you are tempted to play loosely with the authority over you, be most keenly aware that there is One whose authority is never to be tested. To do so is a matter of spiritual life and death! He isn’t called King of Kings for nothing.

[from “[*Wisdom for the Trenches*](#)” by Dr. Larry W. Poland]

Thank you for downloading this free resource!

We're grateful you've taken this step in your spiritual journey. Your growth in Christ encourages us, and we pray this has been a blessing—strengthening your faith, deepening your understanding of God's Word, and equipping you to live for His glory.

Share Your Thoughts

Your feedback helps us improve future resources and encourages others:

Leave a Review or Send Us a Note — If you found this helpful, please consider leaving a short review. Your honest words make a big difference! We love hearing how God is using these materials in your life.

Share Your Story → equip.jesonline.com/reviews/share

Discover More Free Resources

Continue growing in your walk with Jesus. Here are additional tools from the JO EQUIP library and JesusOnline Ministries:

- **Explore the Free Books** → equip.jesonline.com/books
- **Download the Free JO App** — Your personal discipleship hub with the NET Bible, daily devotions, interactive studies, prayer tools, more books, and videos. [Download for Android](#) · [Download for iOS](#) · Explore in browser → app.jesonline.com
- **Watch Video Playlists** → equip.jesonline.com/playlists
- **Visit JesusOnline Ministries** — For more about this ministry and global outreach: jesonlineministries.org

Would you like to help others? Share this resource (or the download link) with friends, your small group, or your church. Every copy planted can bear eternal fruit!

Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

Apologetics • Evangelism • Discipleship • Equipping